The Growth of Aged Whisky in India

India's whisky industry has shifted dramatically from a blended-dominated market to a dominant seller of premium single malts. With a unique climate that accelerates maturation, whipping up Indian whiskies is nothing short of magic. The scotch is aged for decades and is of exceptional quality, but Indian whisky also seems to lock in step with it.

Across the world, aged whisky has long been believed to be a marker of quality. However, Indian whisky is now set to challenge this belief. On one hand, Expedition whiskies stand testament to the country's capability to produce long-matured malts, and on the other, many Indian distilleries have already made a name for themselves with No-Age Statement whiskies.

Understanding The Science of Indian Whisky Ageing

The interaction between wood, environment, and spirit is known as whisky ageing and it is quite complex. While other regions of the world make their whisky over decades, Indians have a distinct advantage due to the higher temperatures leading to faster maturation.

Because of the high evaporation rate, distillers must be exacting with their monitoring and cask selection. There is also a risk of over-ageing, which can lead to an unbalanced excess of wood extraction. Master blenders have to make sure that the aged Indian whiskies do not completely lose their refined profiles due to extreme climate conditions.

Amrut, Paul John and Rampur are recognised Indian distilleries that use the climate to their advantage, creating whiskies that are deeply aromatic and rich in flavour. Indian whisky distilleries have mastered the art of whisky making; even as traditional Scottish malts rely on cask extraction, Indian distilleries achieve remarkable depth in flavour in a fraction of the time. This results in whiskies that are full-bodied and expressive.

The Rise of Aged Indian Whisky

Apart from the new Amrut Expedition, the oldest Indian whisky standing at 15 years is the Rampur Signature Reserve, another Indian whisky that redefines excellence. This limited edition whisky was put to age peacefully in American Standard Oak Barrels for over 15 years, withering many Indian Summers. These four unique casks, handpicked and reserved for the Master Maker, were then transferred in specially selected PX Sherry Butt from Jerez, Spain for its final years of maturation.

In commemoration of Rampur Distillery's 75th anniversary, Radico Khaitan introduced a superb luxury variant of Rampur Indian single malt whisky to the international market. The Rampur Signature Reserve has become the only Indian whisky, at launch, to command a price tag of ₹5 lakh per bottle. It is one of the oldest malts from India. Rampur Distillery, located at the foothills of the Himalayas has extreme seasonal temperatures. This, combined with a unique ageing environment has provided a richer and deeper flavoured whisky.

Not only are all these distilleries innovating and evolving Indian whiskies, but they are also shifting the perception of India as a serious contender in the global whisky domain.

